
Problem 2: Chickasaw Stress

(17 marks)

Here are some words in Chickasaw and their meanings. The words are in a phonetic notation where the exact sounds are not important, but:

- o, a, i are vowels, and : after a vowel indicates that the vowel is long
- ʃ, ɬ, ʔ, and the other letters are consonants
- ' at the beginning of a syllable indicates primary stress (i.e. emphasis) on that syllable, and ˌ indicates secondary stress

Word	Meaning	Word	Meaning
tʃo'ka:ˌno	fly	ˌmaʃ'ko:ˌkiʔ	(name of a tribe)
ˌlok'tʃok	mud	ˌokˌfok'kol	(type of snail)
'a:ˌtʃomˌpaʔ	local store	ta'la:ˌnomˌpaʔ	telephone
iˌbiɬ'kan	snot, mucus	'na:ɬtoˌkaʔ	policeman
ʃan'tiʔ	rat	a'bo:koˌʃiʔ	river
'sa:ɬkoˌna	earthworm	noˌtak'fa	jaw
ˌtʃon'kaʃ	heart	tʃiˌkaʃ'ʃaʔ	Chickasaw
fa'la:t	crow	ˌok'tʃa:ˌlinˌtʃiʔ	saviour

Assignment 1: (7 marks)

If you are given a new Chickasaw word, how would you identify the syllables? Then, what steps would you take to determine which syllables get primary stress and which ones get secondary stress?

Assignment 2: (10 marks)

Here are some more words in Chickasaw. Mark the stress with ' and , at the beginning of the syllables that carry primary and secondary stress, respectively.

	Word	Meaning
(a)	taʔossa:pontaʔ	finance company
(b)	ʃimmano:liʔ	(name of a tribe)
(c)	kanannak	(type of lizard)
(d)	intikba:t	sibling
(e)	okta:k	prairie

– Saujas Vaduguru
